

DARTMOUTH TUCK

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT TUCK

The Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth stands out amongst its Ivey League peers for its small class and rural location in Hanover, New Hampshire. With only 280 MBA students, Tuck is one of the smallest MBA cohorts of any top-tier MBA program. It is also alone in its peer group for awarding only one degree: the full-time, two-year MBA. The small class size and sole focus on the full-time MBA program is credited with promoting strong relationships between students, professors, and administrators. While there is no part-time or Executive MBA on offer, Tuck offers joint or dual degrees in conjunction with Dartmouth and other leading universities.

Tuck is widely known for its close-knit and collaborative community, and unlike many MBA programs, most Tuck MBA students live on campus in dorms. The program places emphasis on collaborative working and team-based learning, experiences they believe help participants to develop the “emotional intelligence and self-awareness to achieve meaningful growth as a leader.” The close community is reported to carry on through the alumni, who are said to among the most supportive and responsive of any elite business school. They are also among the most generous; the school reports a higher proportion of alumni donating back to the school than any of its peers.

Experiential learning is also fundamental to the program design; from the first year students complete a project for existing companies as consultants.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

General Management and Strategy.

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
BusinessWeek	7	20	2	2	*	2
Financial Times	18	16	15	16	10	18
Forbes	5	-	6	-	-	-
The Economist	8	12	12	-	*	-
US News	8	10	12	12	10	10

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants	2,282	Avg GMAT	726
MBA Class Size	287	Avg GPA	3.52
Admissions selectivity	33.4%	% International	43%
Yield	37.65%	% Women	45%
Total Tuition	US\$155,040		

POST-MBA CAREERS

Consulting	38%
Financial Services	20%
Technology	11%
Going into Business	2%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

BCG, McKinsey & Company, Bain & Company, Amazon, Deloitte, Barclays, Bank of America, EY-Parthenon, Danaher, Google

AVERAGE BASE SALARY:	US\$175,000
SALARY INCREASE:	124%%
EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS:	98%



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR TUCK APPLICATION

BY AMY HUGO

Amy Hugo has coached candidates to admissions success at a wide array of top programs, from Dartmouth Tuck, Wharton, Columbia, and Kellogg to London Business School, where she served as Senior Manager.



Tuck is transparent about what they look for in a strong MBA candidate. They want students that are “smart, accomplished, aware, and encouraging”.

1

TUCK WANTS STUDENTS THAT ARE "SMART, ACCOMPLISHED, AWARE AND ENCOURAGING"

Tuck is transparent about what they look for in a strong MBA candidate. As stated online:

Tuck students are **smart**, curious, and engaged.

Tuck students are **accomplished**, impactful, and principled.

Tuck students are **aware**, ambitious, and purposeful.

Tuck students are **encouraging**, collaborative, and empathetic.

It's important to know from the beginning that they use these four criteria as a framework to evaluate every piece of your application. They will be looking for evidence of you demonstrating these behaviours in your past actions, so be sure to think of examples that highlight them well in your essays, your recommendation forms and during your interview. Tuck have very applicant-friendly tips on their website and admissions blogs to help you with your application. We have consolidated them for you and added our own thoughts below.

DEMONSTRATING AWARE, AMBITIOUS, AND PURPOSEFUL.

2

With the awareness criterion, Tuck will be wanting you to demonstrate that you know exactly who you are (your values, strengths and weaknesses), where you're going and why, AND that you know exactly how Tuck will help you get there. Though demonstrating your love and enthusiasm for Tuck is great, even more important will be demonstrating that you truly know and understand how Tuck will help you on your journey and that you know how you will contribute to Tuck. In the essays and at interview, they will want to see evidence that you have taken the time to get to know Tuck and to reflect on your personal connection with the school. Given the tight-knit community, visiting campus before applying would be extremely beneficial.

Regarding being ambitious, the admissions team state that they hope you have your “head in the clouds and your feet on the ground,” which means they want a good balance between ambition and long-term impact and practical, logical steps on how to get there.

With Tuck’s mission being “to develop wise, decisive leaders who better the world through business” (they even require each student to take at least one minicourse that explores the complex ethical and social challenges of business) – demonstrating an understanding of the relationship between society, ethics and business, and a desire to have a part in making a difference, will resonate with Tuck.

3

DEMONSTRATING ACCOMPLISHED, IMPACTFUL, AND PRINCIPLED

The Tuck admissions team will be looking for evidence of this in your career progression, professional achievements and track record, but also in the impact you have had and your accomplishments outside work. Promotions, awards, increased responsibilities etc, will all help them see this. As ever though, it is not only the outcomes Tuck are interested in, but the way you achieved them and the behaviours you used to get there. Examples that highlight this – particularly in your references, will be critical, so be sure to choose recommenders who worked closely enough with you to give enough depth and detail on how you worked and how you interacted with others, in order to achieve these outcomes.

DEMONSTRATING ENCOURAGING, COLLABORATIVE, AND EMPATHETIC.

4

Tuck's relatively small class size lends itself extremely well to the encouraging criterion and makes for an incredibly close-knit community where you will literally get to know everyone.

Encouraging, collaborative and empathetic is outlined as 'quintessential Tuck' and relates strongly to the 'niceness' one so often hears about when talking about Tuck. But recently Tuck has evolved from the previous 'nice' criterion to these more descriptive and action-based words - encouraging, collaborative and empathetic.

It's important to recognise that these behaviours don't necessarily mean always simply being 'nice' - as quite often to successfully collaborate and encourage, you need to push people out of their comfort zones, for example, or encourage challenging conversations rather than avoid them, in order to reach a certain goal. Tuck has a heavy emphasis on building trust-based relationships and will be looking for evidence of this. Their 3rd essay addresses this directly, asking about a time when you invested in someone's success. You could opt to give the perfect 'encouraging' story all neatly wrapped up, but even better would be to take the opportunity to highlight your leadership and teamwork by demonstrating how you both encouraged and challenged, for example, and that it wasn't easy - for you or the others involved.

Bear in mind also that simply by listing involvement in charitable activities does not necessarily demonstrate this encouraging/nice criterion - the team will be more interested in how you do things as opposed to simply what you do. So, the actions you took in a 'for-profit' related activity could demonstrate your encouraging behaviour just as well, for example.

5

DEMONSTRATING SMART, CURIOUS, AND ENGAGED

All business schools want candidates who have excelled academically and professionally, with a competitive GMAT and GPA. They all want to know that you will be able to excel on their demanding MBA programme. However, Tuck will be looking deeper and will want you to demonstrate intellectual curiosity, and a thirst for continual learning and improvement. They very much seek candidates who have a growth mindset and who recognise that though they may have already accomplished a lot, there is always room for improvement and growth.

Though Tuck do like to see consistently strong performance in your academics, they encourage you to not disqualify yourself from applying based purely on your grades, especially if you feel you can demonstrate their criteria in other, compelling ways. Aside from grades, you can still demonstrate you are smart and intellectually curious through your past actions and behaviours in your essays and recommendation letters, and at interview. Showing creative thinking, problem solving, a willingness to learn and improve etc.

Read insider essay strategies for Tuck [here](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	FINAL DECISION
Round 1	25 Sept 2023	07 Dec 2023
Round 2	04 January 2024	14 March 2024
Round 3	25 March 2024	02 May 2024

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**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, MIT Sloan, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

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